

ανηλεος 2:13 [20%]

The only **f**³⁵ MSS included in *ECM*, 18 and 35, are falsely attributed to a different variant, so that this reading is not even mentioned in *ECM*; nor is it mentioned by von Soden. Beyond any question this is the reading of **f**³⁵, but only as further MSS are collated will we know if it survived in other lines of transmission. That someone would have introduced an Attic form in the middle ages is scarcely credible, so **f**³⁵ is early, and in my opinion most probably original.

ιθυνοντος 3:4 [21%]

All eight non-**f**³⁵ MSS, as listed by *ECM*,¹ have a distinct profile, some radically so. However, three of them (1270, 1297, 1598) are obviously related and presumably had a common ancestor not too far back. So we have six independent lines of transmission (outside of **f**³⁵) that probably go back to the early centuries. Oops, cursive 1595, though fairly different from the three, would likely join them by the fifth century, leaving five lines. Also, as the distance in time increases it becomes increasingly unlikely that an ancient classical spelling could, or would, be introduced. This reading is certainly ancient, and in my opinion most probably original.

δυναμενος 3:2 **ℵ** [23%]

To my surprise, there is absolutely **no** overlap between the eight non-**f**³⁵ MSS that *ECM* lists for *ιθυνοντος* and the 23 non-**f**³⁵ MSS listed for *δυναμενος*. To my further surprise, the 23 do not include a single Byzantine MS.² So **f**³⁵ is totally independent of **K**^x here, and yet is joined by **ℵ**, so we already know that the reading is early. But let's analyze the cursives.

Since no two have an identical profile, the 23 are presumably independent in their own generation. However, there are several pairs with a common ancestor not too far back, presumably—I put 206-429, 254-1524 and 630-2200 in this category. But the first two pairs are themselves related, with a common grand-ancestor. The ancestor of 630-2200 is joined by 2138 and their grand-ancestor by 2495. 621 and 2412 meet several generations back. So back in the fifth century, I would imagine, we have sixteen independent lines of transmission (outside of **f**³⁵). By the time

¹ *Editio Critica Maior*, The Institute for New Testament Textual Research, ed (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1997), vol. IV, Catholic epistles.

² *ECM* does list two as Byzantine (254, 1827) but comparing them with *TuT* they do not get above the 80% threshold in James.